

21. THE PHARYNGEAL TONSIL

DURATION : 09:22

STUDY SHEET

COURSE SUMMARY

This video delves into the importance of the pharyngeal tonsils in the immune system and explores their connection to the sphenobasilar system. Students will learn how the mobility of the sphenobasilar synchondrosis is vital for immune balance and bodily exchanges, as well as the impact of intestinal imbalances on ENT health. Craniosacral therapy is also highlighted as a strategy to strengthen the immune system. In addition, practical advice regarding the treatment of conditions such as tonsillitis and sinusitis, taking into account anatomy and physiological movements, is provided. This knowledge will enable therapists to adapt their approach based on the crucial immune development of children.

THE PHARYNGEAL TONSIL: IMPORTANCE AND INTERACTIONS

The **pharyngeal tonsils** play a crucial role in the immune system, particularly in the **pharynx**. They are part of a complex known as **Waldeyer's ring** and depend on the dynamics of the **sphenobasilar system**. The latter is essential for respiratory and digestive defence, and contributes to immune balance.

Good **mobility of the sphenobasilar symphysis** is paramount, as it allows the opening and closing of small channels that facilitate immune recognition and exchanges. Treatment of the entire **craniosacral system** also improves the immune system.

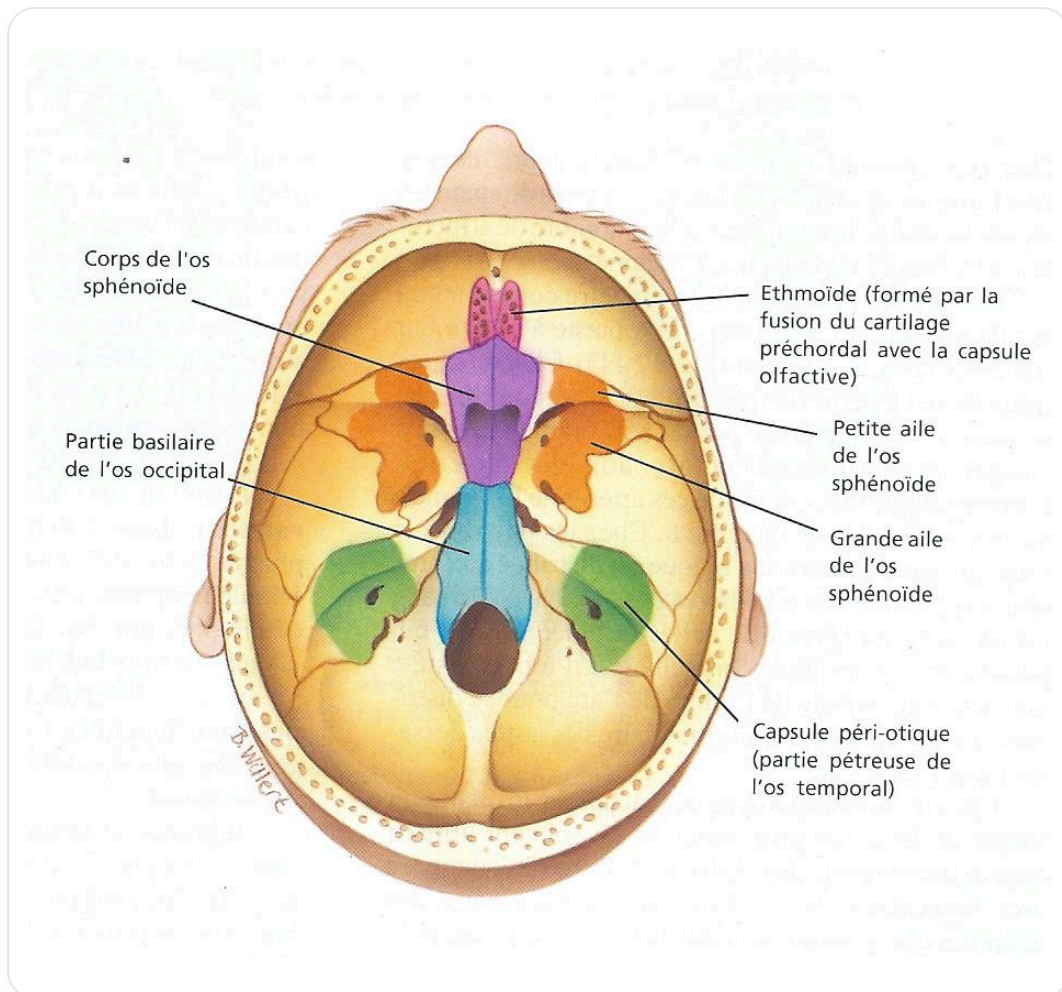


FIG. — *Cranial base superior view*

On a molecular level, the **tonsil** system contains **immunoglobulins** and **lymphocytes** similar to those found in the **caecum**, which can be considered a digestive tonsil. To treat ENT conditions such as **pharyngitis**, **tonsillitis**, **rhinitis**, and **bronchitis**, it is crucial to also intervene on the digestive level, as intestinal imbalances can affect the immune system.

It is important to note that in children, manipulation of the caecum must be done with caution, as destabilisation can have significant consequences. The caecum is also linked to the **liver**, and hepatic destabilisation can lead to problems at the caecal level, thus affecting the immune system.

The first ten years of life are crucial for the development of the immune system. At this stage, the integration and maturation of this system occur.

The **greater omentum** and the **lesser sac** influence the movement of the stomach and its relationship with the lesser pelvis on tissue, hormonal, and immune levels. The **Eustachian tube** is a key element, as it is continuous with the tongue. Each swallow helps to rebalance the inner ear, highlighting the importance of this movement.

Seromucous otitis in children can be due to the horizontality of the ear canal, which limits mucus flow. Overproduction of mucus, often linked to allergic phenomena, can worsen the situation. Over time, around the age of 7, the ear canal becomes more vertical, facilitating flow.

It is sometimes necessary to restore pressure in the ear, for example by using a device that allows a balloon to be inflated while swallowing. Children's behaviour can also be influenced by environmental or dietary factors, which can affect their auditory health.

At the age of 7, children reach the **age of reason**, a time when their sinuses open and pneumatise, coinciding with the maturation of the thyroid. The maxillary sinuses are related to the **adrenal glands**, and children with recurrent sinusitis should be evaluated for imbalances that occurred during their development.

The **Eustachian tube** is also linked to the sphenobasilar symphysis, and a blockage of the sphenoids can hinder the proper functioning of surrounding structures. The **pterygoids** play an important vascular role, reabsorbing tensions in the intramandibular system.

The tongue acts as a vagal stabiliser, and disturbances at the level of the mandible or hyoid bone can affect the stability of the tongue. The depth of the tongue is linked to the **thyroid**, and body posture depends on heart health.

Sensations in the throat or stomach are not necessarily linked to high blood pressure, but can be manifestations of deep impulses. The information received can be vibratory rather than purely physiological, which explains the importance of **frequencies** and **mantras** in certain traditions, such as **OM**, which purifies the body, speech, and mind.